

ASSEMBLY

Since assembly is the closest you'll ever come to actually "talking" to a computer, it's only appropriate that we start our journey into programming languages with it.

Programmable devices have long fascinated humans, even before the advent of computers. As long as two centuries ago we had music boxes, tiny mechanisms that produced music encoded as pins on a cylinder. It wasn't long before it was possible to switch out cylinders and have the same mechanism play new melodies. These aren't even the oldest programmable devices.

Bits may have replaced pins, hard drives may have replaced cylinders, and transistors may have replaced cogs and gears, but the principle of programmable machines remains the same. Essentially it was a device created once, but capable of following instructions that were possibly not even conceived when it was created.



A music box with interchangeable cylinders for different melodies.